

Project Design Phase
Problem – Solution Fit Template

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Project Name	BookStore
Maximum Marks	2 Marks

Problem – Solution Fit Template:BookStore

The Problem-Solution Fit simply means that you have found a problem with your customer and that the solution you have realized for it actually solves the customer's problem. It helps entrepreneurs, marketers and corporate innovators identify behavioral patterns and recognize what would work.

1. Customer Segment(s) [CS]

- Passionate Readers: Individuals who read regularly and are always on the lookout for their next book.
- Casual Explorers: People who enjoy discovering new genres, trending titles, or revisiting classics.
- Gift Shoppers: Users looking to find and purchase the perfect book for friends or family.

2. Jobs-to-be-Done / Problems [J&P]

- Finding the Right Book: Discovering titles that precisely match their personal taste, language preference, and preferred genre.
- Evaluating Book Quality: Reading trustworthy, consolidated user reviews to decide if a book is worth their time/money.
- Seamless Purchasing/Reserving: Securing a copy of a book quickly without navigating complex checkouts.
- Reading on the Go: Browsing and managing their book lists across different devices (desktop, tablet, mobile).

3. Triggers [TR]

- Finishing a Book: The immediate desire to start a new book after turning the final page of the last one.
- Social & Media Buzz: Hearing about a trending book on social media (e.g., BookTok, Bookstagram) or in the news.
- Special Occasions: Upcoming holidays, birthdays, or events requiring a thoughtful gift.
- Leisure Time: Having free time (during commutes, weekends) and wanting to browse for reading material.

4. Emotions: Before / After [EM]

- Before (The Pain):

- o Overwhelmed by massive, disorganized online catalogs.
- o Frustrated by clunky, slow websites that don't work well on mobile.
- o Hesitant to buy because of a lack of clear reviews or personalized guidance.

- After (The Value):

- o Excited and inspired by tailored, high-quality recommendations.
 - o Satisfied with a smooth, rapid check-out or reservation process.
 - o In Control of their reading journey across all of their devices.
5. Available Solutions [AS]

Existing Solution	Pros	Cons
Physical Bookstores	Tactile experience, immediate physical ownership.	Limited inventory, requires travel, no quick search or filter options.
Massive E-Commerce Giants (e.g., Amazon)	Massive inventory, fast shipping.	Cluttered interface, lacks a dedicated community feel, impersonal.
Local Libraries	Free to borrow.	Long wait times for popular releases, physical return deadlines, limited stock.

6. Customer Constraints [CC]

- Time Constraints: Busy schedules prevent users from visiting physical bookstores.
- Device Limitations: Users rely heavily on mobile phones and tablets during commutes, requiring an flawless responsive design.
- Decision Fatigue: Too many options online without curation makes choosing a book exhausting.
- Budget & Access: The need to choose between buying a book immediately or reserving it to manage spending.

7. Behaviour [BE]

- Searching for Recommendations: Asking friends, checking online forums, or looking up "best books of the year" lists.
- Cross-Referencing: Checking multiple platforms to read reviews, compare prices, and see if a book is in stock.

- Impulse Saving: Bookmarking or taking screenshots of books they hear about to look up later.

8. Channels of Behaviour [CH]

- 8.1 Online:
 - Goodreads and online book blogs.
 - Social media platforms (TikTok, Instagram, Reddit communities).
 - Search engines (Googling book summaries).
- 8.2 Offline:
 - Local book clubs and discussion groups.
 - Browsing physical libraries or bookstore displays.
 - Word-of-mouth recommendations from friends and family.

9. Problem Root Cause [RC]

Why does this problem exist?

Traditional book-buying is fragmented. Physical stores have limited shelf space and require travel, while massive online retailers treat books like any other commodity—resulting in cluttered interfaces that lack community-focused curation, personalized recommendation systems, and seamless cross-device reading integration.

10. Your Solution [SL]

- The MERN-Stack BookStore Platform:
 - Vast, Curated Collection: A single, fast destination covering every genre, author, and language.
 - Personalized Recommendation Engine: Smart suggestions matching user tastes, reducing decision fatigue.
 - Interactive Reviews & Easy Operations: Integrated user reviews paired with a simplified "buy or reserve" system in just a few clicks.
 - Fully Responsive MERN Architecture: Fast, reliable performance built on MongoDB, Express, React, and Node.js, optimized flawlessly for computers, tablets, and smartphones.